

BIDDING AFTER A MAJOR OPENING

Partner opens 1 Heart or 1 Spade. Choose your response by fit and strength:

- Simple raise 2M: 6-10 support points, 3+ trumps
- Forcing 1NT: 6-12, forcing one round, neither promises nor denies a fit
- New suit: your own suit, forcing (1-level shows 4+, 2-level is game-forcing)
- Limit raise 3M: 11-12 support points, 4 trumps
- Jacoby 2NT: game-forcing raise, 4+ trumps
- Splinter: game-forcing raise with a singleton or void
- Preemptive 4M: weak and shapely, 5+ trumps
- Pass: fewer than 6 points

Opener then rebids to describe the hand. Practice from both chairs.

4NT is Roman Keycard Blackwood (1430) with a trump suit agreed, or quantitative (inviting 6NT) in a notrump auction.

Keycard responses:

- 5♣ = 1 or 4 keycards
- 5♦ = 0 or 3
- 5♥ = 2 without the trump queen
- 5♠ = 2 with the trump queen